

# JOHN KEELLS A JOURNEY EXCEEDING 150 YEARS GROWING WITH THE NATION

**John Keells Group the largest business conglomerate in Sri Lanka commemorates 155 years in business as at year 2025, growing with the nation of partnering country's growth and delivering exceptional value to their stakeholders.**

Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts is its primary hotel brand, operating under John Keells Hotels (JKH) offering a diverse chain of properties in Sri Lanka and the Maldives. Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts brand was launched in 2005 is the luxury hospitality arm of John Keells Holdings PLC, comprising a diverse collection of hotels, resorts, and integrated developments in Sri Lanka and the Maldives, offering experiences from city luxury and beach resorts to nature-based retreats.

John Keells Group has been a trusted name and an integral part of the Sri Lankan economy through its innovation, good governance, professional management and strategic partnerships with the efficient leadership of Krishan Balendra as Chairperson-CEO of John Keells Holdings PLC. (His father Ken Balendra was also a former Chairman of JKH). Krishan is also the present Chairman of the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce and Ken was also formerly. It is the first time in The Ceylon Chamber's 186-year history where both father and son assumed the position of Chairmanship. Krishan is also the Hon. Consul General of the Republic of Poland in Sri Lanka and was a former Chair of the Employers Federation of Ceylon, Nations Trust Bank and the Colombo Stock Exchange. He joined JKH in 2002 with a law degree (LLB) from the University of London and an MBA from INSEAD.

The John Keells Group operates across seven industry sectors and is home to some of Sri Lanka's much-loved brands and provides careers to over 14,000 people in a respectful and inclusive workplace. Its commitment to their values are; integrity, trust, caring, excellence, and innovation, ensuring ethical and sustainable business practices, to project JKH as Sri Lanka's most respected entity. Cinnamon is an inspired hotelier presenting tradition with elegance across Sri Lanka and the Maldives. It is the Sri Lanka's largest hotel chain and specialize in nature and culture based destination travel. The warmth of Sri Lankan hospitality is always hand delivered

through their Cinnamon Colombo Hotels, Cinnamon Sri Lanka Resorts, Cinnamon Maldives Resorts, and South Asia's largest integrated resort - Cinnamon Life at City of Dreams. Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts represents a modern chain of hotels focused on vibrant hospitality, comfort, creativity, and a journey of discovery rooted in local culture and traditions.

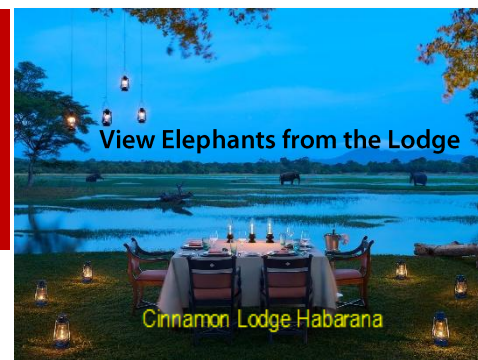


**Key Properties Include** recently inaugurated Cinnamon Life City of Dreams, Cinnamon Grand Colombo, Cinnamon Lakeside Colombo, Cinnamon Red Colombo, Cinnamon Bentota Beach-Signature Selection, Cinnamon Lodge Habarana, Cinnamon, Cinnamon Bay Beruwela, Cinnamon Wild Yala, Cinnamon Citadel Kandy, Habarana Village by Cinnamon, Trinco Blu by Cinnamon, Hikka Tranz by Cinnamon, Kandy Myst by wala, and in the Maldives; Cinnamon Velifushi, Cinnamon Hakuraa Huraa, Cinnamon Dhonveli and Ellaidhoo Maldives by Cinnamon.



**Krishan Balendra**  
Chairperson-CEO  
John Keells Holdings

*"Live with us to live the story of each destination we are present in across Sri Lanka and the Maldives. Discover a love for tropical island luxury with our hotels & resorts. Our deep roots to the natural and cultural heritage of every place we call home, is celebrated with you. What we believe in Inspiring moments, through personally celebrating what's important to you, in every destination that has celebrate the cuisine,*



*culture, and creativity of each our name. We are the heart of every destination we live in. We know the paths and waters that must be explored in every place we call home. We reside in. We empower and uplift the communities, we locale we share space with. We are a source of experience, education, entertainment, and enlightenment wherever we exist. We respect our lands, waters, wildlife, colleagues, and communities. This guides everything we do. We base over 35 humanitarian and conservation projects on the needs of the destinations we are present in. We are the leisure sector of Sri Lanka's largest listed conglomerate - John Keells Holdings PLC".*

John Keells Holdings diversified into the tourism industry with the acquisition of Walkers Tours in 1972 and established its first hotel in Habarana in 1973. In 1980s Walker Tours renamed as Hotel Management & Marketing Services Limited. In 1981, they were managing seven resorts with 4 beach resorts on the

Southern Coast; Beach Hotel Bayroo (presently Cinnamon Bay Beruwela), Hotel Swanee Beruwala, Ceysands Hotel Bentota, and Ambalangoda Rest House. The other three resorts were in the countryside the Habarana Lodge, Habarana Village and Kandy Walk Inn, which was later renamed as Cinnamon Citadel Kandy. John Keells acquired Whittall Boustead and gained control of Bentota Beach Hotel and Coral Gardens Hotel (Presently Hikka Tranz by Cinnamon).

In 1990s, Hotel Management & Marketing Services Limited renamed as John Keells Hotels. In 1993, John Keells owned and managed 900 rooms which accounted for 16% of the room capacity of resorts located outside Colombo. John Keells ventured into the Maldives market in 1996 with the acquisition of the 80-roomed Velidhu Resort Hotel. John Keells hotel chain underwent a major restructuring in 2004. All resorts, including listed resorts and Maldivian resorts brought under one holding company, Keells Hotels Limited.

John Keells Hotels introduced the "Chaaya Hotels & Resorts" brand at ITB Berlin in 2007. The brand took its name from the Sanskrit word Chaaya meaning image. Habarana Village was the first resort to be re-launched under the new brand after refurbishment. Subsequently, other all other resorts were also re-launched under Chaaya brand. Finally the Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts brand was completed in 2015. Cinnamon Lodge Habarana was the first rebranded hotel of the John Keells Hotels.

- Claude Gunasekera